

What's News

Business & Finance

- ◆ **Warner Bros. Discovery** CEO David Zaslav is in the fight of his professional life to stop the company from being swallowed by rival entertainment giant Paramount. **A1**
- ◆ **GM posted surprisingly** strong results in the face of tariffs, a slowing electric-vehicle market and supply crunches, fueling the stock's best day in five years. **B1**
- ◆ **Netflix reported higher** revenue and profit for the third quarter, driven by membership growth, increased ad revenue and price hikes. **B1**
- ◆ **Strong earnings reports** briefly helped power the Dow above 47000 for the first time Tuesday, as the index rose 0.5%. The S&P 500 was little changed while the Nasdaq dropped 0.2%. **B10**
- ◆ **Jana Partners, Travis Kelce** and other investors have a combined stake of about 9% of Six Flags shares, or \$200 million. **B1**
- ◆ **The nonprofit foundation** that controls Novo Nordisk forced a shake-up of its board of directors. **B2**
- ◆ **Coca-Cola said** that higher prices, a better mix of products and a small increase in volumes lifted its sales and earnings in the third quarter. **B2**
- ◆ **Unilever is pushing back** the planned spinoff of its ice-cream business, home to brands including Ben & Jerry's and Magnum. **B3**
- ◆ **Adidas said it expects a** sharper increase in earnings this year than previously expected after booking higher revenue and fatter profit margins in the most recent quarter. **B3**

World-Wide

- ◆ **The Trump administration** is pushing Argentina to limit China's influence over the distressed South American nation at the same time the U.S. and Wall Street banks are working on a \$40 billion lifeline for the country. **A1**
- ◆ **Trump nominee** Paul Ingrasia withdrew from a Senate confirmation hearing to lead a White House ethics watchdog office, following a report that he made racist and antisemitic comments in texts. **A2**
- ◆ **Trump offered his** strongest endorsement yet of a roughly \$240 billion plan to sell nuclear-powered submarines to Australia, calming fears that his administration would pull out of the deal. **A3**
- ◆ **Hamas released** the bodies of two more Israeli hostages as the group and Israel came under increasing pressure from the U.S. to avoid escalation that could collapse the cease-fire in Gaza. **A7**
- ◆ **The Trump administration** plans to release more than \$3 billion in aid to U.S. farmers that had been frozen as a result of the shutdown. **A3**
- ◆ **Marco Rubio has been** the top official executing an aggressive Trump administration campaign to pressure Venezuela's Maduro. **A6**
- ◆ **Saudi Arabia's de facto** leader will visit Washington in November and meet Trump in the Oval Office. **A7**
- ◆ **Sanae Takaichi was** confirmed as Japan's first female prime minister in a parliamentary vote. **A9**
- ◆ **Trump said a summit** with Putin on the Ukraine war would be a 'waste of time.' **A8**

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Japan Makes History With First Female Leader



FRESH START: Sanae Takachi was applauded Tuesday after being chosen Japan's first female prime minister in a narrow parliamentary vote. The 64-year-old conservative favors closer ties to the U.S. and a hawkish stance toward China. **A9**

Tech's Biggest Players Tether Futures to Altman and OpenAI

By BERBER JIN

Jensen Huang was wrapping up a trip celebrating the Lunar New Year in Asia this past January when Masayoshi Son, the chief executive of SoftBank, stood alongside Sam Altman at the White House to unveil what was billed as the largest AI infrastructure project in history. For almost a decade, the Nvidia chief executive had supplied the AI chips that powered OpenAI's rise. Huang wanted to

be the one unveiling such a giant deal with OpenAI's CEO, according to people familiar with his thinking. Soon after, Nvidia secretly pitched OpenAI on a similar project, offering to effectively sideline SoftBank and help raise the funds needed to build new data centers itself. The talks culminated in a giant \$100-billion deal between the two companies, announced at Nvidia's Santa Clara headquarters last month.

"This is the largest computing project in history," Huang said. Altman might not have intended to give Huang FOMO, or the fear of missing out, but he had that effect. And it is getting contagious. To achieve his vision of securing seemingly endless computing power for OpenAI, Altman has gone on a dealmaking blitz, playing the egos of Silicon Valley's giants off one another as they race to cash in

on OpenAI's future growth. The resulting game of financial one-upmanship has tied the fates of the world's biggest semiconductor and cloud companies—and vast swaths of the U.S. economy—to OpenAI, essentially making it too big to fail. All of them are now betting on the success of a startup that is nowhere near turning a

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◆ **Heard on the Street: Fears** for retailers in ChatGPT...**B11**

Louvre Loot Descends Into a Murky Underworld

By KELLY CROW

After a group of thieves brazenly broke into Paris's Louvre Museum and snatched eight pieces of jewelry that form part of France's crown jewels, the chase is on to find them before they filter into the black market. The fear: that these historic artifacts could be dismantled and sold for parts. "Everybody in the business is talking about this right now," said Robert Wittman, a former art-crime investigator with the Federal Bureau of Investigation who runs his own art-recovery practice. By everybody, he means both jewelry thieves and the private investigating firms who make a living hunting them down.

The clandestine global network for stolen art, including jewels, trades billions of dollars' worth of illicit pieces a year, according to the FBI, stretching from diamond-cutting shops in Dubai and Delhi to jewelers in New York, Antwerp and Tel Aviv. The U.S. alone logs more than \$1.2 billion in jewelry thefts a year. If there is no reward or chance for a quick ransom, private investigators said the thieves will likely seek to smuggle the Louvre's stolen gems to black-market jewelers willing to re-cut and reshape the bigger jewels into smaller, untraceable ones that can be resold anywhere.

Unlike Picasso paintings or Rolex watches, stolen gems can be broken out of their jewelry settings and their gold settings can be melted down because such commodities retain value as precious metals and gems. They won't fetch as much without the luster of

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Sarkozy Begins Prison Term



Former French President Nicolas Sarkozy, with wife Carla Bruni, leaves Paris home to start a five-year sentence after he was convicted of conspiring to seek campaign funds from Libya's Gadhafi. **A8**

China's Retirees Roam This Park To Find Spouses for Their Children

Hopeful grandparents carry paper profiles listing their unwed grandchildren's key stats

By HANNAH MIAO

CHONGQING, China—Every Friday and Saturday morning, hundreds pour into a hilltop park in this southwestern Chinese city looking for love. It's a real-life version of a dating app—except the people "swiping" are mostly retirees eager to find spouses for their adult children. They call it a *xiangqin jiao*, which translates to "match-making corner." In English, it's often dubbed a "marriage market." It involves paper résumés that function as dating profiles. There's the standard information: gender, age, height, job and what they want in a partner. But some include details that would be taboo in the U.S., like weight, earnings and whether the parents have

pensions. Many don't include a photo or name. One volunteer matchmaker, an older woman known as Sister Gao, comes each week with dozens of profiles for attendees to browse. She spends much of her time reassuring parents who don't understand why their children haven't gotten hitched. "Our generation's concept of marriage just isn't the same as today's," Gao said. "In our generation, people put up with a lot. Today, young people think, 'why should I settle?'" Kids these days, you might have heard, aren't getting married. The picture in China is particularly bleak. In the country of more than a billion, just 6.1 million couples registered their marriages in 2024, according to government data,

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U.S. Urges Argentina To Curb China Ties

By BRIAN SCHWARTZ

WASHINGTON—The Trump administration is pushing officials in Argentina to limit China's influence over the distressed South American nation at the same time the U.S. and Wall Street banks are working on a \$40 billion lifeline to the country. Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent has spoken in recent weeks with Luis Caputo, Argentina's economic minister, about curbing China's ability to access the country's resources, including critical minerals. In addition, they have discussed granting the U.S. expanded access to the country's uranium supply, people with knowledge of the conversations said. Administration officials are trying to counter Beijing's influence by encouraging Argentina's leaders to strike deals with U.S. companies as a way to jump-start infrastructure

projects and investments in key sectors such as telecommunications, the people said. China is Argentina's second-largest trading partner after Brazil and the top buyer of its agricultural exports. "Stabilizing Argentina is America First. We do not want another failed state in Latin America, and a strong, stable Argentina helps anchor a prosperous Western Hemisphere, which is explicitly in the strategic interest of the United States," a Treasury Department spokesman said. A spokeswoman for Argentina's Finance Ministry declined to comment. A spokesman for Milei didn't respond to requests for comment. The conversations come as

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- ◆ **Rubio leads campaign** against Venezuela..... **A6**
- ◆ **Colombian president** courts Trump fight..... **A6**

Lush Campus Becomes A Magnet for Rich Kids

By ROSHAN FERNANDEZ

HIGH POINT, N.C.—On a typical weeknight, students at High Point University might sit down to filet mignon at "1924 PRIME," the on-campus steakhouse. This isn't a mere perk. Servers are told to coach the young diners on body language, professional attire, which fork to use and when to salt their food. It's one of the striking amenities at High Point, which prides itself on preparing students for the rigors of a career—and has also become a favorite of affluent families. "Half of Wall Street sends their kids to this school," President Nido Qubein said in

an interview. Universities nationwide are battling to pad their balance sheets by attracting families who will pay full sticker price, particularly as the Trump administration slashes funding. High Point is something of a blueprint. Its model—catering to a wealthier student body—has fueled its enrollment growth, campus expansion and financial stability. Dozens of manicured gardens adorn the lush grounds. Students are almost always within earshot of a fountain. Classical music plays around campus, and there are six outdoor heated swimming pools, each accompanied by a hot tub.

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